

How people play the Maia bots on Lichess

A complete three-year census of **rated** games, placed beside a separate all-time snapshot that includes casual play.

Read this distinction first. "Bot-game entries" adds the three Maia account totals; one Maia-vs-Maia game can contribute two entries. "Unique games" counts each game ID once. These are different only when the bots play each other. The all-time snapshot has 21 such overlaps. The three-year rated export has none, so its entry and unique-game counts are equal. All-time includes casual play; detailed monthly, player, clock and rating analyses below do not.

6,486,805

all-time bot-game entries · rated + casual

6,486,784

all-time unique games

1,425,567

rated games in three-year export

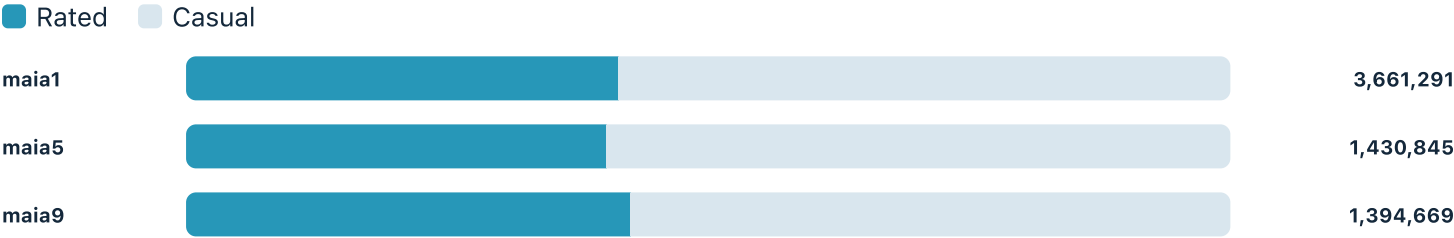
93,020

opposing Lichess accounts

01 / BROAD CONTEXT

All games, including casual

These moving Lichess profile counters were captured **4 October 2026 at 07:12 UTC**. They cover each bot's entire account history, not just the three-year study. They cannot establish monthly casual-play trends.



Bot	All game entries	Rated	Casual
maia1	3,661,291	1,513,490	2,147,801
maia5	1,430,845	575,010	855,835
maia9	1,394,669	592,961	801,708
Total bot entries	6,486,805	2,681,461	3,805,344

6,486,805

summed bot entries

– 21

Maia-vs-Maia duplicate entries

6,486,784

unique games

Casual = all profile games – rated profile games. The overlap comes from pairwise Maia-bot crosstables. These are game counts, not a count of people.

02 / DETAILED CENSUS

Rated games in the last three years

The downloadable game-level export covers games **finished 4 October 2023 00:00 UTC through, but not including, 4 October 2026 09:00 UTC**. It contains no casual games. Every game ID appears once; no game between two Maia bots occurred in this window.

Bot	Rated game entries	Opposing accounts	Bot White	Bot Black
maia1	835,333	77,549	366,298	469,035
maia5	288,278	21,652	126,214	162,064
maia9	301,956	21,842	136,092	165,864
Total entries	1,425,567	93,020	628,604	796,963

1,425,567

bot-game entries

– 0

cross-bot overlaps

1,425,567

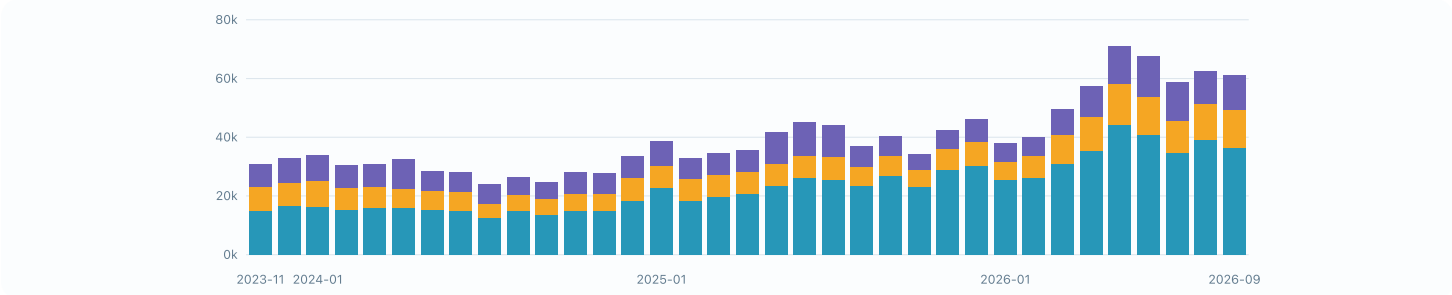
unique rated games

Popularity grew, but not smoothly

Comparable 12-month blocks: 350,152 → 628,041 games (+79.4%).

The comparison is November 2023–October 2024 versus October 2025–September 2026. The strongest complete month was 2026-05 (70,936 games). This is rated-play growth, not a claim about all Maia games.

Maia 1
Maia 5
Maia 9



Bot	First complete 12 months	Last complete 12 months	Change
maia1	182,173	395,277	+117.0%
maia5	78,888	119,533	+51.5%
maia9	89,091	113,231	+27.1%
All bot entries	350,152	628,041	+79.4%

▼ Every complete UTC month — all bot entries and unique games

October 2023 (29,225) and October 2026 (6,919) are **partial months** and are intentionally omitted below and from the trend comparison. “All entries” and “unique games” match in every row because this export has zero Maia-vs-Maia overlap.

UTC month	Maia 1 entries	Maia 5 entries	Maia 9 entries	All entries	Unique games
2023-11	15,025	7,934	7,830	30,789	30,789
2023-12	16,716	7,592	8,489	32,797	32,797
2024-01	16,318	8,794	8,782	33,894	33,894
2024-02	15,337	7,402	7,773	30,512	30,512
2024-03	16,080	7,070	7,541	30,691	30,691
2024-04	16,146	6,209	10,011	32,366	32,366
2024-05	15,347	6,294	6,602	28,243	28,243
2024-06	14,909	6,448	6,550	27,907	27,907
2024-07	12,660	4,640	6,490	23,790	23,790
2024-08	15,068	5,354	6,101	26,523	26,523
2024-09	13,626	5,216	5,722	24,564	24,564
2024-10	14,941	5,935	7,200	28,076	28,076
2024-11	15,024	5,700	6,852	27,576	27,576
2024-12	18,592	7,528	7,253	33,373	33,373
2025-01	22,725	7,575	8,240	38,540	38,540
2025-02	18,333	7,513	7,078	32,924	32,924
2025-03	19,614	7,577	7,477	34,668	34,668
2025-04	20,713	7,635	7,149	35,497	35,497
2025-05	23,450	7,720	10,669	41,839	41,839
2025-06	26,275	7,525	11,412	45,212	45,212
2025-07	25,369	8,052	10,832	44,253	44,253
2025-08	23,557	6,510	6,908	36,975	36,975
2025-09	26,776	7,095	6,502	40,373	40,373
2025-10	23,076	5,833	5,321	34,230	34,230
2025-11	28,745	7,096	6,444	42,285	42,285
2025-12	30,216	8,251	7,752	46,219	46,219
2026-01	25,542	6,138	6,221	37,901	37,901
2026-02	26,263	7,367	6,229	39,859	39,859
2026-03	30,903	9,930	8,576	49,409	49,409
2026-04	35,524	11,322	10,385	57,231	57,231
2026-05	44,199	13,968	12,769	70,936	70,936
2026-06	40,730	13,263	13,650	67,643	67,643
2026-07	34,756	10,934	13,130	58,820	58,820
2026-08	39,090	12,248	11,039	62,377	62,377
2026-09	36,233	13,183	11,715	61,131	61,131

Many one-off visitors, a small very active core

93,020

opposing accounts

45.2%

played exactly one game

21,193

played multiple Maia levels

57.7%

of games came from busiest 1%

The median account played 2 games. The busiest account played 13,951. Accounts are public Lichess handles, not verified unique people; 147 games have no opponent handle and are excluded from account statistics.

Most active public accounts in this rated window

Public Lichess account	Games	Maia 1	Maia 5	Maia 9
toadp	13,951	13,780	171	0
shaartah	12,413	10,796	1,610	7
humanoid_1800	10,865	213	220	10,432
colaptes	8,009	0	7,991	18
bwvolker	7,425	908	6,177	340
clemson2024	7,073	6,254	768	51
amoroso	6,798	6,684	113	1
anationofconquerors	6,697	6,619	76	2
golismeando-manchego	6,527	0	0	6,527
sunshine_arete	6,004	0	310	5,694

Counts are for this three-year rated export only. They are not all-time leaderboards.

Does playing Maia make people improve?

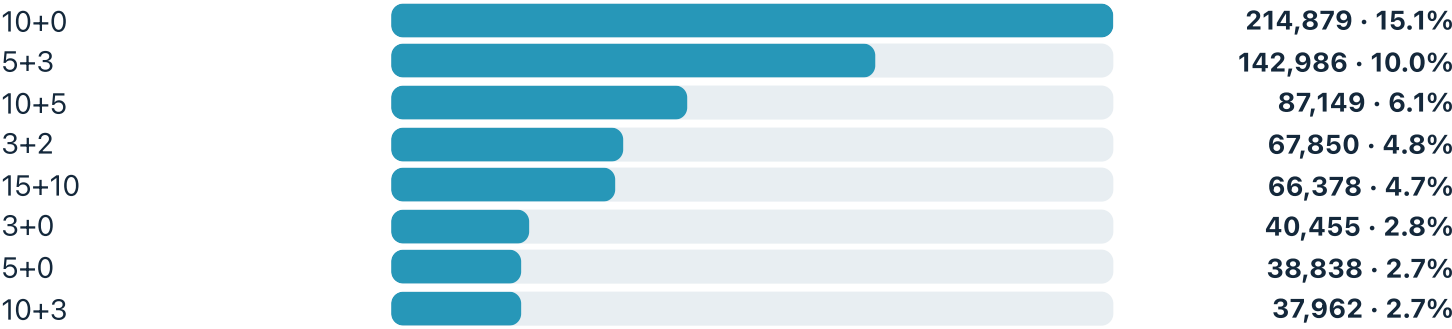
This dataset cannot establish that. Of 2,629 accounts with at least 20 games spanning 180 days, the last observed Maia opponent was a higher-numbered bot for 696, lower for 355, and unchanged for 1,578. First/last opponents are noisy snapshots, not a learning measure or causal test.

04 / HOW THEY PLAY

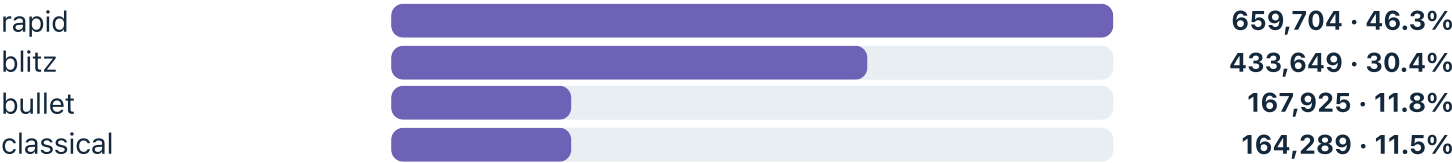
10+0 leads; stronger bots draw higher-rated opponents

Exact controls show initial minutes plus increment seconds. Speed categories are broader Lichess labels.

Exact clock settings



Speed categories



Opponents' Lichess ratings at game time

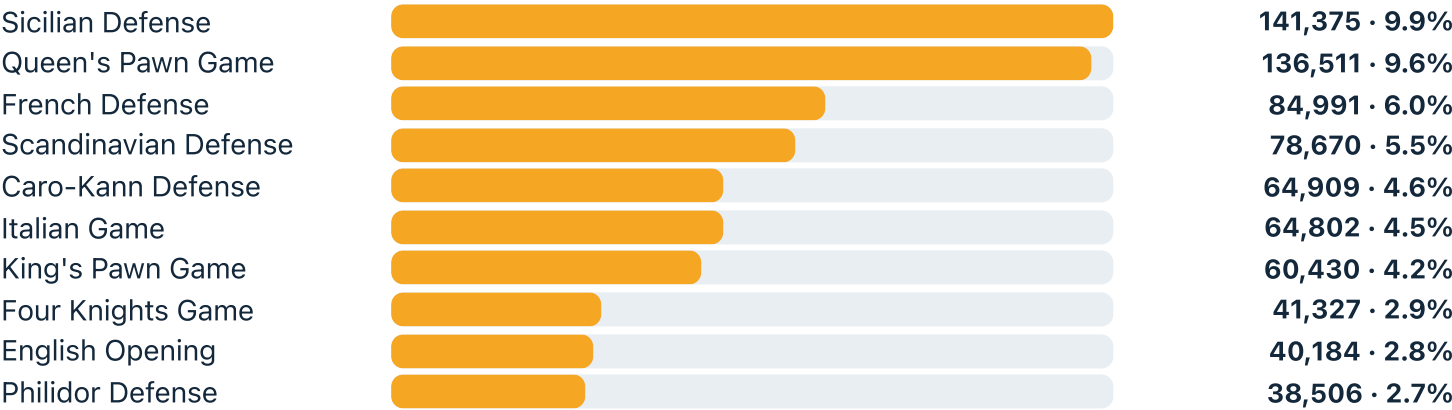
These are Lichess ratings, not FIDE Elo. A game-weighted mean gives frequent players more influence; an account-weighted mean first averages each account's ratings. Players may choose different speeds and bots, so this is not a controlled ability comparison.

Opponent	Game-weighted mean	Account-weighted mean	Median	Middle 80%
maia1	1,453	1,411	1,463	1,145–1,750
maia5	1,570	1,488	1,561	1,299–1,840
maia9	1,631	1,561	1,630	1,337–1,908
All Maia games	1,515	1,438	—	—

Missing opponent ratings: 0 among games with identified opponents. Games with no opponent handle are excluded from rating averages.

Most common named opening families

Opening labels are Lichess metadata, grouped before a colon. They describe the position reached by both sides, not the human's first move. Moves were not downloaded.



05 / METHODS & DATA

Download, inspect, reproduce

The companion dataset contains all 1,425,567 rated game metadata rows in compressed year/bot CSV shards, their SHA-256 manifest, a field guide, aggregate JSON, and the standard-library scripts used to export and rebuild this report. **No move lists or PGNs were collected.**

Validation checked unique game IDs, the frozen finish-time bounds, complete gap-free date coverage, the filtered-export cap, field presence, and shard hashes. The original private working SQLite database and credentials are not included.

Sources: [Lichess profiles](#), [bot crosstables](#), [user-game export](#). Lichess data retain their own terms; the repository's MIT license applies to original code and writing. Independent fan research, not a Lichess or Maia publication.

[Game-file manifest](#) · [All aggregate tables \(JSON\)](#) · [Field guide](#) · [Research plan](#)